उत्सवाः

My Sanskrit Festival Workbook

संस्कृत-उत्सव-अभ्यास-पुस्तिका

Dīpāvalī · Gaṇeśa Caturthī · Navarātri & Vijayadaśamī · Oṇam · Makara Saṅkrānti · Holi · Rakṣābandhana

Name / नाम: _____

Free to print and share

How to use · कथं प्रयोक्तव्यम्

1. Each festival has two pages: words, then a śloka and small exercises.
2. Read each word aloud: first the Devanagari, then the sound (transliteration).
3. Learn the śloka slowly, one line a day, and read its meaning.
4. Do the exercises, then try the mixed quiz and check the answer key.
5. Use the greetings page to wish your family and friends in Sanskrit!

> Tip: words ending in -ḥ (ः) or -m (म्) are the usual naming forms. Some festival names here are given in Roman letters in Malayalam too, so you can recognise them.

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Dīpāvalī · दीपावली

Dīpāvalī means “a row of lamps”. Families clean their homes, draw raṅgavallī at the door, light lamps on the new-moon night of Kārttika, worship Lakṣmī and share sweets. It celebrates light over darkness.

Festival words · शब्दाः

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
दीपः	dīpaḥ	lamp
दीपावली	dīpāvalī	row of lamps
प्रकाशः	prakāśaḥ	light
तैलम्	tailam	oil
वर्तिका	vartikā	wick
लक्ष्मीपूजा	lakṣmīpūjā	worship of Lakṣmī
रङ्गवल्ली	raṅgavallī	rangoli (coloured floor design)
मिष्टान्नम्	miṣṭānnam	sweets
नूतनवस्त्रम्	nūtanavastram	new clothes
अमावास्या	amāvāsyā	new-moon night

Dīpāvalī: śloka & practice

शुभं करोति कल्याणम् आरोग्यं धनसम्पदः ।
शत्रुबुद्धिविनाशाय दीपज्योतिर्नमोऽस्तु ते ॥

śubhaṃ karoti kalyāṇam ārogyaṃ dhanasampadaḥ |
śatrubuddhivināśāya dīpajyotir namo’stu te ||

Meaning: Salutations to you, light of the lamp, who bring goodness, well-being, health and wealth, and who remove hostile thoughts.

तमसो मा ज्योतिर्गमय । (tamaso mā jyotir gamaya: Lead me from darkness to light.)

1. Write the meaning

1. दीपः _____
2. तैलम् _____
3. रङ्गवल्ली _____

2. Write in Sanskrit

4. row of lamps _____
5. new-moon night _____

3. Copy the first line

🐘 Gaṇeśa Caturthī · गणेशचतुर्थी

On the fourth day (caturthī) of the bright half of Bhādrapada, families welcome Gaṇeśa home, offer modakas and dūrvā grass, sing together and, at the end, carry the image for visarjana (immersion).

Festival words · शब्दाः

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
गणेशः	gaṇeśaḥ	Gaṇeśa
गणपतिः	gaṇapatiḥ	lord of the gaṇas
चतुर्थी	caturthī	the fourth day
मोदकः	modakaḥ	modaka (sweet dumpling)
मूषकः	mūṣakaḥ	mouse (Gaṇeśa's vehicle)
एकदन्तः	ekadantaḥ	the one-tusked one
लम्बोदरः	lambodaraḥ	the big-bellied one
विघ्नहर्ता	vighnahartā	remover of obstacles
दूर्वा	dūrvā	dūrvā grass
विसर्जनम्	visarjanam	immersion

Gaṇeśa Caturthī: śloka & practice

वक्रतुण्ड महाकाय सूर्यकोटिसमप्रभ ।
निर्विघ्नं कुरु मे देव सर्वकार्येषु सर्वदा ॥

vakratuṇḍa mahākāya sūryakoṭisamaprabha |
nirvighnaṃ kuru me deva sarvakāryeṣu sarvadā ||

Meaning: O Lord with the curved trunk and mighty body, shining like a crore suns, please make all my work free of obstacles, always.

1. Write the meaning

1. गणेशः _____
2. मोदकः _____
3. लम्बोदरः _____

2. Write in Sanskrit

4. lord of the gaṇas _____
5. immersion _____

3. Copy the first line

🏹 Navarātri & Vijayadaśamī · नवरात्रिः विजयदशमी च

For nine nights (Navarātri) the Devī is worshipped as Durgā, Lakṣmī and Sarasvatī. Books and tools are honoured (Sarasvatī-pūjā, Āyudha-pūjā). The tenth day, Vijayadaśamī (Dasarā), celebrates victory; in many places śamī leaves are exchanged and children begin learning (vidyārambha).

Festival words · शब्दाः

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
नवरात्रिः	navarātriḥ	nine nights
दुर्गा	durgā	Durgā
सरस्वतीपूजा	sarasvatīpūjā	worship of Sarasvatī
आयुधपूजा	āyudhapūjā	worship of tools
विजयः	vijayaḥ	victory
दशमी	daśamī	the tenth day
विजयदशमी	vijayadaśamī	the tenth day of victory
शमीवृक्षः	śamīvṛkṣaḥ	śamī tree
विद्यारम्भः	vidyārambhaḥ	beginning of learning
महिषासुरमर्दिनी	mahiṣāsuramardinī	she who defeated Mahiṣāsura

Navarātri & Vijayadaśamī: śloka & practice

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु शक्तिरूपेण संस्थिता ।
नमस्तस्यै नमस्तस्यै नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥

yā devī sarvabhūteṣu śaktirūpeṇa saṃsthitā |
namas tasyai namas tasyai namas tasyai namo namaḥ ||

Meaning: To the Goddess who lives in all beings as strength (śakti): salutations to her, again and again.

1. Write the meaning

1. नवरात्रिः _____
2. आयुधपूजा _____
3. विजयदशमी _____

2. Write in Sanskrit

4. Durgā _____
5. she who defeated Mahiṣāsura _____

3. Copy the first line

🌼 Oṇam · ओणम्

Oṇam is Kerala's harvest festival in the month of Chingam, remembering the good king Mahābali and Vāmana. Homes make flower carpets (pookkalam), families share a big feast on banana leaves (sadya), and there are boat races (vallam kali) and swings (oonjal). The main day, Thiruvonam, falls on the Śravaṇa star.

Festival words · शब्दाः

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
श्रवणम्	śravaṇam	Śravaṇa star (Thiruvonam day)
महाबलिः	mahābaliḥ	King Mahābali
वामनः	vāmanaḥ	Vāmana
पुष्परङ्गवल्ली	puṣparaṅgavallī	flower carpet (Malayalam: pookkalam)
भोजनम्	bhojanam	feast, meal (Malayalam: sadya)
कदलीपत्रम्	kadalīpatram	banana leaf
नौकास्पर्धा	naukāspardhā	boat race (Malayalam: vallam kali)
दोला	dolā	swing (Malayalam: oonjal)
उत्सवः	utsavaḥ	festival
केरलम्	keralam	Kerala

Oṇam: śloka & practice

सर्वे भवन्तु सुखिनः सर्वे सन्तु निरामयाः ।
सर्वे भद्राणि पश्यन्तु मा कश्चिद् दुःखभाग्भवेत् ॥

sarve bhavantu sukhinaḥ sarve santu nirāmayāḥ |
sarve bhadrāṇi paśyantu mā kaścid duḥkhabhāg bhavet ||

Meaning: May all be happy, may all be free from illness, may all see good things, may no one suffer. (Oṇam remembers a time when everyone was equal and happy.)

1. Write the meaning

1. श्रवणम् _____
2. पुष्परङ्गवल्ली _____
3. नौकास्पर्धा _____

2. Write in Sanskrit

4. King Mahābali _____
5. Kerala _____

3. Copy the first line

Makara Saṅkrānti · मकरसङ्क्रान्तिः

When the sun enters Makara (Capricorn) in mid-January, its northward course (uttarāyaṇa) is celebrated. People take a holy bath, give gifts, fly kites and share sesame and jaggery sweets. It is a harvest festival with many regional names.

Festival words · शब्दाः

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
मकरसङ्क्रान्तिः	makarasaṅkrāntiḥ	sun entering Makara
सूर्यः	sūryaḥ	sun
उत्तरायणम्	uttarāyaṇam	the sun’s northward course
तिलः	tilaḥ	sesame
गुडः	guḍaḥ	jaggery
तिलगुडम्	tilaguḍam	sesame-jaggery sweet
पतङ्गः	pataṅgaḥ	kite
दानम्	dānam	giving, gift
स्नानम्	snānam	bath
धान्यम्	dhānyam	grain, harvest

Makara Saṅkrānti: śloka & practice

ॐ मित्राय नमः । ॐ रवये नमः । ॐ सूर्याय नमः ।

oṃ mitrāya namaḥ | oṃ ravaye namaḥ | oṃ sūryāya namaḥ |

Meaning: Salutations to the friend of all, to the shining one, to the sun. (The first three Sūrya-namaskāra names.)

तिलगुडं गृहाण, मधुरं वद । (tilaguḍaṃ gṛhāṇa, madhuraṃ vada: Take sesame-jaggery, speak sweetly.)

1. Write the meaning

1. मकरसङ्क्रान्तिः _____
2. तिलः _____
3. पतङ्गः _____

2. Write in Sanskrit

4. sun _____
5. grain, harvest _____

3. Copy the first line

🎨 Holi · होली

Holi welcomes spring on the full moon of Phālguna. On the night before, the Holikā fire recalls how young Prahlāda was protected. Next day everyone plays with colours and shares sweets.

Festival words · शब्दाः

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
होलिका	holikā	Holikā (the bonfire night)
प्रह्लादः	prahlādaḥ	Prahlāda
वसन्तः	vasantaḥ	spring
फाल्गुनः	phālgunaḥ	month of Phālguna
पूर्णिमा	pūrṇimā	full-moon day
रङ्गः	raṅgaḥ	colour
जलम्	jalam	water
हर्षः	harṣaḥ	joy
मित्रम्	mitram	friend

Holi: śloka & practice

असतो मा सद्गमय । तमसो मा ज्योतिर्गमय ।
मृत्योर्मा अमृतं गमय ॥

asato mā sad gamaya | tamaso mā jyotir gamaya |
mṛtyor mā amṛtaṃ gamaya ||

Meaning: Lead me from the unreal to the real, from darkness to light, from death to immortality. (Bṛhadāraṇyaka Upaniṣad 1.3.28)

1. Write the meaning

1. होलिका _____
2. फाल्गुनः _____
3. जलम् _____

2. Write in Sanskrit

4. Prahlāda _____
5. friend _____

3. Copy the first line

🧵 Rakṣābandhana · रक्षाबन्धनम्

On the full moon of Śrāvaṇa, a sister ties a rakṣā (protective thread) on her brother’s wrist and puts a tilaka; the brother promises to protect her, and they share sweets and gifts.

Festival words · शब्दाः

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
रक्षाबन्धनम्	rakṣābandhanam	tying of the protective thread
रक्षा	rakṣā	protection
सूत्रम्	sūtram	thread
भ्राता	bhrātā	brother
भगिनी	bhaginī	sister
तिलकम्	tilakam	mark on the forehead
श्रावणः	śrāvaṇaḥ	month of Śrāvaṇa
उपहारः	upahāraḥ	gift

Rakṣābandhana: śloka & practice

येन बद्धो बली राजा दानवेन्द्रो महाबलः ।
तेन त्वां प्रतिबध्नामि रक्षे मा चल मा चल ॥

yena baddho balī rājā dānavendro mahābalaḥ |
tena tvāṃ pratibadhnāmi rakṣe mā cala mā cala ||

Meaning: With the thread that bound the mighty King Bali, I tie you. O rakṣā, stay firm, do not slip away.

1. Write the meaning

1. रक्षाबन्धनम् _____
2. भ्राता _____
3. श्रावणः _____

2. Write in Sanskrit

4. protection _____
5. gift _____

3. Copy the first line

The six seasons · षड् ऋतवः

The Indian year has six seasons (ṛtu, ऋतु), each two lunar months long. The Gregorian months are approximate, because lunar months shift a little every year.

Season	Sound · meaning	Lunar months	About
वसन्तः	vasantaḥ spring	चैत्रः, वैशाखः Caitra, Vaiśākha	mid-March – mid-May
ग्रीष्मः	grīṣmaḥ summer	ज्येष्ठः, आषाढः Jyeṣṭha, Āṣāḍha	mid-May – mid-July
वर्षाः	varṣāḥ rainy season	श्रावणः, भाद्रपदः Śrāvaṇa, Bhādrapada	mid-July – mid-September
शरत्	śarat autumn	आश्विनः, कार्तिकः Āśvina, Kārttika	mid-September – mid-November
हेमन्तः	hemantaḥ early winter	मार्गशीर्षः, पौषः Mārgaśīrṣa, Pauṣa	mid-November – mid-January
शिशिरः	śiśiraḥ late winter	माघः, फाल्गुनः Māgha, Phālguna	mid-January – mid-March

Seasons: festivals & nature words

Season	Festivals	Nature words
वसन्तः	Ugādi / Gudi Padwa, Rāma Navamī	पुष्पम् (flower), कोकिलः (cuckoo), आम्रः (mango tree)
ग्रीष्मः	Ratha Yātrā	तापः (heat), सूर्यः (sun), छाया (shade)
वर्षाः	Rakṣābandhana, Gaṇeśa Caturthī, Oṇam	मेघः (cloud), वृष्टिः (rain), मयूरः (peacock), मण्डूकः (frog)
शरत्	Navarātri, Vijayadaśamī, Dīpāvalī	चन्द्रः (moon), कमलम् (lotus), आकाशम् (sky)
हेमन्तः	Gītā Jayantī	हिमम् (frost, snow), धान्यम् (grain, harvest)
शिशिरः	Makara Saṅkrānti, Vasanta Pañcamī, Mahāśivarātri, Holi	शीतम् (cold), अग्निः (fire), वायुः (wind)

Holi falls on the full moon of Phālguna, at the end of Śiśira, welcoming Vasanta. Makara Saṅkrānti (about 14 January) begins the solar Śiśira.

Exercise · ऋतवः

1. श्रावणः and भाद्रपदः belong to _____ .
2. Dīpāvalī comes in _____ .
3. The season of cuckoos and mango blossoms is _____ .
4. शीतम् (cold) is a word for _____ .
5. Write the six seasons in order: _____

Mixed quiz · मिश्र-प्रश्नाः

A. Which festival does each word belong to?

1. मोदकः → _____
2. तिलगुडम् → _____
3. शमीवृक्षः → _____
4. रङ्गवल्ली → _____
5. पुष्परङ्गवल्ली (pookkalam) → _____
6. रक्षा → _____
7. होलिका → _____
8. पतङ्गः → _____
9. मूषकः → _____
10. दीपः → _____
11. नवरात्रिः → _____
12. महाबलिः → _____

B. Finish the line

13. वक्रतुण्ड महाकाय _____
14. तमसो मा _____
15. सर्वे भवन्तु _____

Festival greetings · उत्सव-शुभाशयाः

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
दीपावलीशुभाशयाः	dīpāvalīśubhāśayāḥ	Happy Dīpāvalī!
गणेशचतुर्थीशुभाशयाः	gaṇeśacaturthīśubhāśayāḥ	Happy Gaṇeśa Caturthī!
विजयदशमीशुभाशयाः	vijayadaśamīśubhāśayāḥ	Happy Vijayadaśamī!
ओणम्-शुभाशयाः	oṇam-śubhāśayāḥ	Happy Oṇam!
मकरसङ्क्रान्तिशुभाशयाः	makarasaṅkrāntiśubhāśayāḥ	Happy Makara Saṅkrānti!
होलिकोत्सवशुभाशयाः	holikotsavaśubhāśayāḥ	Happy Holi!
रक्षाबन्धनशुभाशयाः	rakṣābandhanaśubhāśayāḥ	Happy Rakṣābandhana!
तिलगुडं गृहाण, मधुरं वद।	tilaguḍaṃ gṛhāṇa, madhuraṃ vada	Take sesame-jaggery, speak sweetly.
भवते / भवत्यै शुभाशयाः।	bhavate / bhavatyai śubhāśayāḥ	Best wishes to you (to a man / a woman).

Make a greeting card

To / प्रति: _____

_____ शुभाशयाः!

From / इति: _____

Answer key · उत्तराणि (1)

Festival exercises (1-5 on each śloka page)

Dīpāvalī	1 lamp · 2 oil · 3 rangoli (coloured floor design) · 4 दीपावली · 5 अमावास्या
Gaṇeśa Caturthī	1 Gaṇeśa · 2 modaka (sweet dumpling) · 3 the big-bellied one · 4 गणपतिः · 5 विसर्जनम्
Navarātri & Vijayadaśamī	1 nine nights · 2 worship of tools · 3 the tenth day of victory · 4 दुर्गा · 5 महिषासुरमर्दिनी
Oṇam	1 Śravaṇa star (Thiruvonam day) · 2 flower carpet (Malayalam: pookkalam) · 3 boat race (Malayalam: vallam kali) · 4 महाबलिः · 5 केरलम्
Makara Saṅkrānti	1 sun entering Makara · 2 sesame · 3 kite · 4 सूर्यः · 5 धान्यम्
Holi	1 Holikā (the bonfire night) · 2 month of Phālguna · 3 water · 4 प्रह्लादः · 5 मित्रम्
Rakṣābandhana	1 tying of the protective thread · 2 brother · 3 month of Śrāvaṇa · 4 रक्षा · 5 उपहारः

Answer key · उत्तराणि (2)

Mixed quiz A

1. Gaṇeśa Caturthī
2. Makara Saṅkrānti
3. Vijayadaśamī
4. Dīpāvalī
5. Oṇam
6. Rakṣābandhana
7. Holi
8. Makara Saṅkrānti
9. Gaṇeśa Caturthī
10. Dīpāvalī
11. Navarātri
12. Oṇam

Seasons exercise

1. वर्षाः (varṣāḥ)
2. शरत् (śarat)
3. वसन्तः (vasantaḥ)
4. शिशिरः (śiśiraḥ); हेमन्तः is also accepted
5. वसन्तः, ग्रीष्मः, वर्षाः, शरत्, हेमन्तः, शिशिरः

Mixed quiz B

13. सूर्यकोटिसमप्रभ
14. ज्योतिर्गमय
15. सुखिनः

> शोभनम्! Well done! · उत्सवाः आनन्ददायकाः। (Festivals bring joy.)